

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure Cloud and Hybrid Infrastructure Security | Microsoft Defender
| Microsoft Sentinel

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of experience strengthening security across hybrid infrastructure and Azure cloud environments. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring proven depth across the Microsoft Azure security ecosystem, including Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) with Kusto Query Language (KQL). I have engineered and managed security controls at scale for an organisation of over eight thousand users, leading endpoint protection, identity governance, cloud security posture, threat detection and response, and vulnerability management programmes. I am highly effective in remote and hybrid collaborative environments and skilled at translating technical security findings into clear, actionable recommendations for business stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Azure Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Azure security policies, Zero Trust architecture
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender - 8,000+ user deployment
- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, automated response playbooks, alert triage and detection engineering
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, CrowdStrike NG-SIEM) - Expert
- **Endpoint and Mobile Management:** Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), endpoint compliance policies, application management
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust - just-in-time access, zero standing privilege
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus - full lifecycle scanning and remediation
- **Email Security:** Mimecast email security gateway - anti-phishing, URL rewriting, DLP
- **Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, IDS/IPS, WAF/DDoS protection
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR workflow automation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 methodology, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Engineer and manage security controls across hybrid on-premises and Microsoft Azure infrastructure for over eight thousand users, spanning identity, endpoint, email, cloud, and network security domains
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO configurations, enforcing Zero Trust identity principles and reducing identity-based attack surface
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full estate, centralising Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alerting within the Microsoft 365 Defender console
- Operate Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, building SOAR playbooks, and tuning detections to reduce alert noise and improve fidelity

- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the enterprise, leveraging Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM for endpoint threat detection, prevention, and investigation
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for endpoint and mobile device compliance, enforcing configuration policies and application controls across hybrid cloud and on-premises endpoints
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM for just-in-time privileged access governance, eliminating standing privileges across IT and third-party supplier accounts
- Conduct vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, and Nessus across cloud and on-premises environments, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports for senior stakeholders
- Lead incident response activities in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review processes
- Write PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations, reporting, and routine administrative tasks
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Led the onboarding and initial deployment of Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR, writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) custom analytics rules and building automated response playbooks aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an estate of eight thousand-plus users, establishing unified XDR visibility across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads
- Configured Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, and MFA policies to enforce identity security controls across the Microsoft 365 and Azure environment
- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across eight thousand-plus endpoints, providing enterprise-wide endpoint detection and prevention capability
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM rollout, establishing device compliance policies and mobile application management controls across the estate
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM platform, enforcing least-privilege access and governing privileged account lifecycle across IT and administrative teams
- Conducted regular vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io and Nessus across cloud and on-premises environments
- Supported incident response and forensic investigation processes in line with NIST 800-61, leading lessons-learned reviews and driving post-incident improvements

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained security controls across a SaaS/FinTech cloud infrastructure environment covering endpoint security, network access controls, and Identity and Access Management (IAM)
- Administered MFA, SSO, and access governance policies across Azure-hosted environments to secure developer and customer-facing systems
- Supported cloud vulnerability assessment activities and coordinated remediation of identified security weaknesses across cloud and on-premises environments
- Maintained security documentation and contributed to ISO 27001 audit readiness activities, ensuring controls evidence was accurate and up to date

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and onboarded Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR at UAL from initial setup through to production, delivering custom KQL analytics rules and automated SOAR playbooks, significantly reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR)

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across eight thousand users, establishing enterprise-wide XDR visibility and centralised incident investigation within the Microsoft 365 Defender console
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA rollout across the full user base, reducing identity-based risk and achieving compliance with Cyber Essentials Plus requirements
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across eight thousand-plus endpoints, achieving full endpoint visibility and significantly reducing alert dwell time
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM to govern all privileged access across the IT estate, eliminating shared administrative credentials
- Managed end-to-end vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS, AppCheck, and Nessus, tracking and driving remediation of critical and high findings to closure

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP85,000-95,000 | Remote (UK)